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FREELANCE & WORK

Saudi Freelancer

Document, price, invoice



A DIGITAL GUIDE

Saudi Freelancer Starter Kit

This is the English edition. It is a field guide for selling a service from Saudi Arabia: the Freelance Work Document, a price in riyals, a proposal, and an invoice. It is dated October 2026.

It is not legal, tax, or employment advice. It does not promise that a portal will approve you, that a client will pay you, or that a template is a contract. Read the official page on the day you apply. If a sentence here disagrees with that page, believe the page.

> Work disclaimer. This guide is practical education for starting a small service practice. It is not legal, tax, or employment advice. Contracts, taxes, and conflicts with an existing job depend on where you live and on the agreement you already signed. Have a qualified professional review anything you will sign or file.

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01

How to use this guide

Block two evenings. The first evening is the document and the offer. The second is the price, five messages, and the invoice fields. Do not design a logo until those exist.

- Use the official platform yourself. Do not send your login to a stranger who offers to 'issue it for you.'
- Write dates as you see them. This PDF cannot see a rule that changed after October 2026.
- If you already have a job, read that contract before you message a client.
- Stop when a step says to ask a lawyer or an accountant. That instruction outranks the rest of the file.

Verify with official sources. This guide is education, not legal advice, not a Ministry decision, and not a filing.

Try this. Put the download somewhere you control, then print the field pages. The portal number belongs on paper as well as in the PDF.

02

What the freelance document is

The Freelance Work Document is issued through the official freelance platform at https://freelance.sa. The site's own Arabic name is on that home page. This English PDF does not set Arabic type: the fonts in this file do not shape right-to-left text, so the Arabic name is left on the official site rather than drawn broken here. Check the address bar before you sign in or approve a login request.

The document, when the portal issues one, permits the activities printed on it. It is not a commercial registration from the Ministry of Commerce. It is not a work visa. It does not cancel an employment contract. It does not, by itself, make an online shop legal, and it does not register you for VAT.

Paper	What it is for	What it is not
Freelance Work Document	Approved service activities on the document	A shop, a product line, or every online sale
Commercial registration	A business the Ministry of Commerce registers	Something this PDF can issue
VAT registration	A tax status with ZATCA, if you must or choose to register	A line you add because a template has a box

If you sell goods, run a store, or the activity is not on the portal's list, ask the Ministry of Commerce whether you need a commercial registration. Do not guess from a blog.

03

Before you open the portal

Read these questions before you create an application. The portal will ask its own version. Answer for your real life, not for the life that would be easier to approve.

- ☐ I know which service I will actually sell, in one sentence.
- ☐ I know whether I already have a job, and I have the contract nearby.
- ☐ I am not asking a middleman to use my identity.
- ☐ I can say which activity on the official list matches the work, or I can say that none of them do.
- ☐ I understand a refusal is an answer. This PDF cannot overturn it.

Employment comes first

A government job, a private contract, a scholarship, or a visa can restrict outside work. Those rules have changed before and they are not the same for every person. Read your contract and the question on the screen. If the clause is unclear, ask the person at work who answers that question, or a qualified adviser, and keep the reply. The freelance document does not erase the contract.

Nationality, age, and student status have also been treated differently at different times. This guide will not give you a yes. The portal's question is the yes or the no.

> **Try this.** If a website other than freelance.sa asks for your password or a fee by transfer to a personal account, close it.

04

On the official platform

The steps below are the shape of the process, not a screenshot that will stay true. Labels move. If a button is not where this list says, use the label on the screen.

• Open https://freelance.sa and confirm the host.

• Sign in with the national access method the portal offers. Often that is Nafath. Approve the request only if you started it.

• Read the eligibility questions. Answer them. If you do not qualify, stop.

• Choose an activity from the list the portal shows. Pick the one that matches the work, not the one that sounds broader.

• Read the fee on that page. Do not rely on a remembered number. When this guide was written, the thing to do was to read the fee on the portal, including if the fee was zero.

• Submit. If a document is issued, download it. Write the number, the activities, and the expiry on the field page.

• Note how long it says it lasts, and the renewal path. Do not assume a year if the page says otherwise.

After it arrives

Store the file with your other records. The number is something you can put on a proposal or an invoice if you want the client to see it. It is not a decoration for a service the document does not cover. If you later change the work, go back to the portal and read whether the new work is on the document.

> Written October 2026. Verify the current rules on freelance.sa before you apply, renew, or tell a client you are covered.

05

Price the work in riyals

A price is a floor, a target, and a walk-away number. The floor is the amount below which you will not start. It comes from hours you can defend, not from a stranger's post.

Build the floor

- Write the hours for one job, including messages, revisions, and the evening you lose.
- Write the lowest amount, in SAR, that makes that many hours acceptable beside your job.
- Divide. That is the floor for this offer, not a market rate for your whole city.
- The target is the floor plus a margin you can explain in one sentence, such as revisions or a faster date.
- Walk away below the floor. A discount that breaks the floor is a different, worse job.

Line	Your number
Hours for one job, including revisions	
Lowest acceptable total, SAR	
Floor per job, SAR	
Target, SAR	
Walk-away, SAR	
Deposit before work starts	

Quote in SAR unless the client asked for another currency. If you are paid in another currency, write the rate you actually received, not a rate you hoped for. The riyal's peg is a fact about the currency, not a promise about what a foreign client will send after fees.

> **Try this.** If you cannot say the hours, you cannot say the price. Go back one step.

06

Thirty days beside a job

Thirty days is long enough to learn whether the offer is real. It is not a vow to quit your job. Two evenings and one weekend block is the cap unless you have written a larger cap on purpose.

Days	Job	Stop if
1 to 3	One-sentence offer. Check the employment contract. Open the portal and read the questions.	The contract forbids the work, or the portal says no.
4 to 7	Floor, target, walk-away. One proof piece that is yours, not your employer's files.	You still cannot describe the result the client holds.
8 to 14	Five messages to people you already know. Proposal ready.	You are editing a logo instead of sending the messages.
15 to 23	Follow up once. Do the work only after the deposit rule is met.	You started a job with no deposit and no scope.
24 to 30	Deliver, invoice, and decide: same offer for another thirty days, or stop.	You widened the offer because one person was vague.

A compliment is not a stage in the pipeline. A reply that asks for a price is a stage. Write the next step and a date, or the conversation is a hobby.

07

Where clients actually come from

The first paying clients, when they happen, usually come from people who already know your work or who were introduced by those people. A public account can help later. It is a poor first step if you have not sent five direct messages.

• Former colleagues, classmates, and clients of your employer only if your contract allows it and you are not using the employer's files.

• A local business whose problem you have actually seen. One specific offer, not 'I do design.'

• A professional community you already belong to. Read the rules before you post an offer.

• WhatsApp, email, LinkedIn, or X, whichever you already use with that person. Do not buy a list.

Do not promise a result you do not control, such as 'your sales will double.' Promise a deliverable: a menu, a month of bookkeeping, a translated page, a lesson plan. The deliverable is what the invoice describes.

> This chapter does not promise clients. Most outreaches get no reply. No reply is data. It is not a reason to invent a testimonial.

08

Messages you can edit

Copy the shape, not a personality. Replace every bracket. If a bracket is still there when you press send, you are not ready.

To someone who knows you

Hello [name]. I am taking a small number of [offer] projects beside my job. The result is [what they hold]. It takes about [time] and the price starts at [floor] SAR, with [revision rounds] revisions. If that is useful this month, I can send a one-page scope. If not, no need to reply.

To a business you can name

Hello [name]. I noticed [a specific, true observation, not a fake compliment]. I put together [deliverable] for businesses in that situation. The price is [target] SAR and I start after a deposit. May I send the one-page scope?

A follow-up, once

Hello [name]. I sent a note on [date] about [offer]. I will close the loop on [date]. If the timing is wrong, I will not write again unless you ask.

A no that keeps the relationship

Thank you for looking. I am going to pass, because [scope or date] is outside what I can do well. If you want, I can suggest you talk to [a real person who agreed to be named, or nobody].

> **Try this.** Send five. Then stop and do the work you already sold. A sixth message is not a strategy if the first five were vague.

09

Proposal page

A proposal is a scope, a price, and a date. It is not a contract and it is not a pitch deck. Fill this page and send it as it is, in writing, so the client can say yes to something specific.

Line	Write it
Client	
Date	
Your name	
Freelance document number, if you have one and want it here	
The result they will hold	

Line	Write it
Included	
Not included	
Revision rounds	
Calendar time	
Price, SAR	
Deposit to start	
What you need from them, and by when	

If they say yes in a chat, repeat the scope and the price in one message and ask them to confirm. A voice note is a weak record. Keep the confirmation.

10

Scope, deposits, and contracts

Ask for a deposit before you start. A common pattern is part at the start and the rest on delivery, or the full amount for a small job. The amount is your rule, written before the client asks for a discount. A deposit is not rude. It is how you avoid financing a stranger.

When the work grows, stop and reprice. 'Can you also' is a new line on the proposal, not a favor that eats the floor.

What to take to a qualified person

This is a checklist, not a contract. Do not paste it into an email and call it legal. Have a lawyer licensed where the agreement matters review anything you will sign, especially if the amount is large, the client is abroad, or you are unsure about your employment contract.

- ☐ Who the parties are, and that you are allowed to do this work.
- ☐ The deliverable, the revision limit, and what 'done' means.
- ☐ The date, the price in SAR, and the deposit.
- ☐ What happens if they stop, or if you stop.
- ☐ Who owns the files after payment.
- ☐ How a dispute would be raised. Do not invent a court.

> Not legal advice. A PDF cannot see the agreement you already signed at your job, and it cannot see the client's country.

11

Invoice page

Send the invoice when the agreement says you have earned it, not when you feel awkward. Number it. Keep a copy. This page is a bill. It is not ZATCA e-invoicing software and it is not a compliant e-invoice.

Field	Write it
Invoice number and date	
Your name	
Freelance document number, optional	
Client name	
Description of the work	
Amount, SAR	
VAT, only if you are registered. Otherwise write 'not VAT registered'	
Total due, SAR	
How they can pay you	
Date you were paid, filled later	

If you are not registered for VAT, do not add 15 percent because a sample invoice had a VAT line. If you are registered, follow ZATCA's current invoice rules, which are stricter than this page. The next chapter is the list of questions, not the answers.

12

VAT, zakat, and your accountant

Tax rules depend on what you are, what you sell, and the current ZATCA publications. This page is a list of things to verify. It is not a calculation of what you owe.

What was published, and what you must re-check

ZATCA's standard VAT rate has been 15 percent since 1 July 2020. Confirm the rate on zatca.gov.sa before you charge it. For many years ZATCA has published a mandatory VAT registration threshold of SAR 375,000 of taxable supplies in twelve months, and a voluntary band from SAR 187,500. Confirm both numbers on zatca.gov.sa. They are included so you know which page to open, not so you can skip opening it. This paragraph was written in October 2026.

- Am I required to register for VAT, or am I allowed to register voluntarily?
- If I register, what must the invoice contain, and does e-invoicing (Fatoora) apply to me yet?
- If I am not registered, how do I show that on a bill without pretending?
- Does zakat apply to me, and how is it filed? Do not invent a zakat percentage from this PDF.
- Does my employment, or a license I already hold, change any of this?
- What records do I keep, and for how long?

A separate note of the percentage you set aside is a habit, not a tax filing. The accountant, or ZATCA's own guidance, decides the percentage. Until you have asked, do not tell a client you have 'handled the tax.'

> Verify with official sources. Not legal advice. Not tax advice. Not a ZATCA ruling.

13

Records and a simple pipeline

Keep a folder that is not your chat app. The portal PDF, the proposal you sent, the confirmation, the invoice, and the proof of payment. If a client disputes the scope in three months, the folder is the argument. Your memory is not.

Name	Stage	Last contact	Next step	Date
	Idea			
	Message sent			
	Proposal sent			
	Deposit in			
	Delivered			
	Paid			

Stages move forward only when the thing in the stage happened. 'They seemed interested' stays at message sent. Five names is enough. A pipeline of thirty strangers you have not written to is a wish list.

- [ ] The freelance document file is saved outside the browser.
- [ ] The expiry date is on the field page.
- [ ] Each yes has a written scope.
- [ ] Each invoice has a number.
- [ ] The accountant question, if I still have one, has a date next to it.

14

A worked example

This is a composite, not a client and not a testimonial. Call her N. She works in an office in Dammam and can design simple menus. She wanted weekend work. She did not yet have a sentence, a price, or a document.

She opened freelance.sa and checked the host before she signed in. She read the eligibility questions and answered them for her real situation. The activity she chose matched menu design, not a shop and not goods she would stock. She saved the document the portal issued, wrote the number and the expiry on the field page, and did not treat it as a commercial registration.

Her floor came from ten honest hours and the lowest monthly amount that made those hours worth it beside her job. She quoted in SAR, with two revision rounds, and a deposit before she started. The first five messages went to people she already knew. Two replied. One became a proposal. The deposit arrived in week four. The other reply stayed a compliment.

She set aside a percentage of the deposit and booked a conversation with an accountant before she added VAT to anything. The guide did not find the client. The portal, the sentence, and the five messages did. Nothing here is a promise that you will be approved or paid.

If your week does not look like this one, do not force the resemblance. Copy the structure: a baseline, one change at a time, a written review, and a stop when the tool is the wrong tool. The names above are teaching composites, not testimonials and not promises.

15

Field pages

Print this. The portal answer and the price are useless if they stay in your head. Write what the official page said on the day you read it.

Document record

Field	What the portal showed
Date I checked freelance.sa	
Activity I selected	
Document number, if issued	
Expiry	
Fee shown on the page	
What the portal refused, if it did	

Offer and price

Box	Your words
Who pays	
What they hold at the end	
Not included	
Hours, honestly	
Floor in SAR	
Target in SAR	
Deposit before I start	

- ☐ I read the eligibility questions myself.
- ☐ I did not treat the document as a commercial registration.
- ☐ My employment contract was checked before I sent a message.
- ☐ The invoice does not add VAT unless I am registered.
- ☐ A lawyer or accountant question is written down.

16

Thirty-day log

This log is the part you write. Print it. A guide you only read is a brochure. Thirty lines is a month, and a month is long enough to see whether the method fits.

Days 1 to 15

Day	Portal or client	Sent?	Reply	SAR	Note
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10					
11					
12					
13					
14					
15					

Do not backfill a day you forgot. Leave it blank. A blank line is more useful next month than a number you invented. The lines are tall enough to write in, not just to type a checkmark.

Days 16 to 30

Day	Portal or client	Sent?	Reply	SAR	Note
16					

Day	Portal or client	Sent?	Reply	SAR	Note
17					
18					
19					
20					
21					
22					
23					
24					
25					
26					
27					
28					
29					
30					

Weekly notes

Week	What repeated	What I will change
1		
2		
3		
4		

Week	What repeated	What I will change
5		

Open notes

	Write in the lines

End of the month

Question	Your answer
What actually repeated?	
What did I abandon, and should it stay abandoned?	
What is the one change for next month?	

Question	Your answer
Do I need a person, not a PDF?	
Where is the file saved on my own device?	

- ☐ I can find this PDF without the download link.
- ☐ The license is mine. I have not posted the file.
- ☐ Next month's first action is written in one sentence.
- ☐ If the guide was the wrong tool, I know what I will do instead.

A last word

Use the pages that match the week you are actually having. Print a worksheet if paper helps you tell the truth. Put the file somewhere you can find it. And if a chapter tells you to talk to a licensed professional, that instruction outranks the rest of the PDF.